

in Toulouse, Hamburg, or Tianjin, or a Boeing 737 MAX assembled in Renton, Washington. Airbus accounts for more than 80% of the domestic Indian market by seats. IndiGo, which handles 61.9% of all domestic passengers, operates a fleet that is predominantly Airbus. Nearly 90% of Air India's long-haul capacity is supplied by Boeing. This concentration locks Indian carriers into foreign maintenance, spare-part, pilot-training, and software ecosystems for decades.

Arvind Melligeri, the Executive Chairman and CEO of Aequs, a Belagavi-based maker of aerospace products for both Boeing and Airbus, and the operator of India's first Aerospace SEZ, understands

the architecture from inside. "It is worth noting that globally, the sector is dominated by a few players, irrespective of the segment. For instance, while there may be 26 airframers on paper, the reality is a duopoly, with Airbus and Boeing accounting for 88% of the market. In aircraft manufacturing, there is a reason only a few major players exist. Making aeroplanes is highly complex, with development timelines stretching up to 15 years and platform lifecycles exceeding 20 years. New programmes are therefore rare, even if multiple concepts exist on drawing boards," says Melligeri.

No aviation economy, however large, is fully self-contained. Even

the United States and Europe depend on globally distributed supply chains for engines, avionics, materials, and components. Airbus sources extensively outside Europe, while Boeing's supplier ecosystem spans multiple continents. The question, therefore, is not whether India should be dependent—aviation by design is interdependent—but where it sits in that chain and how much of the value, technology, and strategic control it owns.

Group Captain Venkatesh Chari (Retd), Assistant Vice President (Operations), HoD & SME (Aviation Safety & Quality) at Laminaar Aviation Infotech, who has analysed India's aerospace

The Money Leaving India

- **Leasing:** \$5bn+
- **Overseas MRO:** \$1.5bn
- **Software and systems:** Significant
- **Training and simulators:** Significant
- **Aircraft purchases:** Significant
- **Global aerospace manufacturing share:** ~2% (target ~10%)
- **Certified Indian commercial jet:** 0
- **Certified Indian commercial turbofan:** 0
- **Indian global leasing giant:** none

